NCE EXAM PREP

Practice Exam 10

Domain 4

Provision of Counseling Interventions

34 Practice Questions | 45 minutes

A, B, C answer choices

Answer Key and Explanations included

> **Instructions.** Select the single best answer for each question. Record your answers separately. This domain practice set is drawn from Full-Length Practice Exam 02. Use the suggested 45-minute practice timer. Do not consult Part B until you complete Part A. These domain timings are editorial practice allocations, not official NBCC section limits.

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PART A — QUESTIONS

Choose one answer (A, B, or C) per question.

Question 1

> An adult arrives at a crisis center after a sexual assault and becomes visibly overwhelmed as several available services are described. The person is medically stable and says, “Please stop deciding things for me.”

What should the counselor do?

A) Complete the most time-sensitive referrals first and explain the decisions afterward.

B) Pause, acknowledge the loss of control, and present one option at a time while requesting consent before each next step.

C) Ask the person to choose immediately from the full list so no service opportunity is missed.

Question 2

> A client who pulls hair when studying notices an urge only after reaching toward the scalp. The client wants a concrete behavioral skill and agrees to track the pattern.

Which intervention is the best fit?

A) Ask the client to analyze what the hair pulling symbolizes before changing the behavior.

B) Practice early urge awareness and a competing response that makes pulling difficult for a brief period.

C) Recommend studying only in public settings where embarrassment will prevent the behavior.

Question 3

> A first-generation college student says family members view counseling as selfish because personal problems should remain within the family. The student values family loyalty and also wants help managing stress.

Which intervention is most culturally responsive?

A) Explore both commitments and help the student frame coping goals in a way that can support personal well-being and valued family relationships.

B) Encourage the student to keep counseling secret so family attitudes do not interfere with treatment.

C) Challenge family loyalty as a barrier to the independence needed for emotional health.

Question 4

A client repeatedly plans to complete a benefits application but postpones it whenever the paperwork feels confusing. The client has identified a trusted friend who is available on Saturday morning and wants a concrete plan.

Which counselor intervention best supports action?

A) Ask the client to visualize the disadvantages of never receiving the benefit.

B) Encourage the client to finish the entire application alone to strengthen self-efficacy.

C) Develop an implementation intention specifying when, where, and how the client will begin with the friend's support.

Question 5

A client has a recurring nightmare after a frightening event. The counselor is trained in imagery rehearsal, and the client is stable, interested in the method, and able to use imagery without becoming overwhelmed.

How should the counselor apply the intervention?

A) Have the client repeatedly imagine the original nightmare without changing it until fear disappears.

B) Help the client create a less distressing ending and rehearse the revised dream imagery while awake.

C) Interpret each image as a symbol of an unresolved unconscious conflict.

Question 6

At an initial appointment, a client says, "I'm not sure what I'm supposed to do here. Are you going to tell me how to fix my life?"

What is the counselor's best response?

A) Explain that counseling is collaborative, describe how the counselor and client may work together, and ask what kind of help the client expected.

B) Reassure the client that the counselor will provide clear solutions once enough background information has been collected.

C) Begin asking about symptoms because uncertainty usually decreases after the formal assessment is completed.

Question 7

A client with perfectionistic beliefs predicts, "If I ask a coworker to clarify one instruction, everyone will think I'm incompetent." The client agrees to test the prediction in a low-risk situation.

What should the counselor do next?

A) Collaboratively specify the experiment, the predicted outcome, and what observations the client will record.

B) Assure the client that competent employees ask questions, making an experiment unnecessary.

C) Ask the client to request help with the most consequential work task to produce a decisive result.

Question 8

> With two minutes remaining, a client says, “There’s something important I haven’t told you about my marriage.” The client states there is no immediate safety concern but does not want the issue ignored.

What should the counselor do?

A) Extend the session until the client has fully discussed the issue, regardless of later appointments.

B) Ask the client to wait until the next session because beginning a new topic near closing is inappropriate.

C) Acknowledge the importance, clarify enough to support containment, and agree on how to return to it promptly.

Question 9

> A client reports intermittent suicidal thoughts without current intent or a plan. After a full risk evaluation, the counselor determines that outpatient care with a collaborative safety plan is appropriate under agency procedures. The client is willing to participate.

Which intervention should the counselor use?

A) Ask the client to sign a promise that no self-harm will occur before the next session.

B) Identify warning signs, internal coping steps, supportive contacts, professional resources, and ways to reduce access to lethal means.

C) Provide a crisis-line number and instruct the client to use it if the thoughts become more frequent.

Question 10

> A college student with attention difficulties repeatedly intends to start assignments after dinner but loses track of time while gaming. The student wants a practical strategy and has identified 7:00 p.m. as a realistic start time.

Which intervention best supports follow-through?

A) Create an external cue at 7:00 p.m. and rehearse a specific sequence for pausing the game and opening the assignment.

B) Ask the student to rely on motivation and begin whenever the desire to study becomes strong enough.

C) Explore whether procrastination represents unconscious resistance to academic expectations.

Question 11

> In couple counseling, one bilingual partner pauses while searching for words in English. The other partner repeatedly answers on the person’s behalf. The quieter partner looks frustrated but says nothing.

What is the counselor’s best response?

A) Allow the more fluent partner to interpret because this preserves the couple’s natural communication pattern.

B) Ask the quieter partner to respond only in English so each person’s account can be evaluated consistently.

C) Slow the pace, ask each partner to speak for themself, and explore the quieter partner’s preferred language support.

Question 12

> A client says, “You write throughout the whole session. I can’t tell whether you’re listening to me or filling out a form.” The counselor’s notes are brief and can be taken less frequently.

How should the counselor respond?

A) Explain what the note-taking is for, invite the client’s reaction, and collaborate on an adjustment that supports connection.

B) Stop all note-taking immediately and promise never to write during future sessions.

C) Reassure the client that professional note-taking does not interfere with attentive listening.

Question 13

> A client with persistent worry spends hours each evening mentally reviewing possible problems. Attempts to suppress the thoughts make them return more strongly. The client wants a structured way to reduce the disruption.

Which intervention is most appropriate?

A) Encourage the client to answer every worry with evidence that the feared event cannot occur.

B) Establish a limited scheduled worry period and practice redirecting worry to that period when it appears earlier.

C) Ask the client to avoid all situations that tend to trigger uncertain thoughts.

Question 14

> After describing a relapse in gambling, a client watches the counselor closely and asks, “Are you disappointed in me?” The counselor does not feel disappointed and is unsure what the client observed.

Which response would be most therapeutic?

A) “You’re wondering whether I’m disappointed. What did you notice from me that led you to ask?”

B) “No, counselors are trained not to judge clients for relapses.”

C) “The important issue is how you feel about the relapse, not how I feel about it.”

Question 15

> A client practicing for a job interview asks for feedback. During rehearsal, the client gives thoughtful answers but speaks so softly that the counselor can barely hear them.

Which feedback is most useful?

A) “You need to project confidence if you want an interviewer to take you seriously.”

B) “Your interview skills will improve after you work through the anxiety underneath them.”

C) “Your answers were clear, and I had difficulty hearing the last two. Would you like to practice them at a stronger volume?”

Question 16

> In a counseling group, one member says, “I need extra time to put my thoughts into words.” Other members often finish the member’s sentences or move on during pauses. The member has begun participating less.

What is the leader’s best intervention?

A) Ask the member to prepare written statements before each meeting to keep the discussion moving.

B) Name the pattern, ask the member what would support participation, and invite the group to tolerate a slower pace.

C) Direct the other members to remain completely silent whenever this member begins speaking.

Question 17

How is unconditional positive regard best expressed when a client describes behavior that harmed another person?

A) Maintain respect for the client while openly exploring the behavior, its effects, and responsibility for change.

B) Avoid discussing the harm so the client does not experience the counselor as judgmental.

C) Communicate approval of the behavior to demonstrate complete acceptance of the client.

Question 18

> A counselor trained in exposure and response prevention is guiding a planned contamination exposure. The client asks repeatedly, “You know I won’t get sick from touching this, right?” The client and counselor previously agreed that seeking reassurance maintains the fear cycle.

How should the counselor respond?

A) Remind the client of the agreement and coach the client to notice anxiety without resolving the uncertainty.

B) Reassure the client once so anxiety falls enough to complete the exposure.

C) End the exposure because the reassurance requests show that the client is not ready for this method.

Question 19

Which counselor statement best reflects a client’s meaning rather than only content or feeling?

A) “Being the person everyone depends on seems closely tied to how you measure your worth.”

B) “You handled the bills, scheduled the appointments, and drove everyone to work.”

C) “You feel exhausted and frustrated by how much your family expects from you.”

Question 20

A client comes to a community center several hours after learning that a sibling died unexpectedly. The client is physically safe, denies thoughts of self-harm, and says, “I feel nothing. Does that mean something is wrong with me?”

Which response is most appropriate?

A) Encourage the client to describe the death in detail so the expected emotions will emerge.

B) Explain that early reactions can include numbness, then ask what immediate support would feel most helpful.

C) Interpret the numbness as denial and emphasize the need to begin accepting the loss.

Question 21

An 11-year-old responds “I don’t know” to repeated questions about changing schools but becomes animated while arranging miniature figures on a table. The counselor is trained to use developmentally appropriate expressive activities.

What is the counselor’s best response?

A) Continue asking direct questions because verbal answers are necessary for meaningful counseling.

B) Interpret the figure placed far from the others as proof that the child feels abandoned.

C) Invite the child to show what school has been like with the figures and let the child explain the arrangement.

Question 22

During an office session, an agitated client stands, clenches both fists, moves close to the counselor, and shouts, “You’re going to listen now.” Agency protocol directs counselors to maintain access to an exit and summon trained assistance when behavior becomes threatening.

What should the counselor do?

A) Remain seated to appear nonthreatening and invite the client to explain the anger fully.

B) Create distance toward the accessible exit, state a clear behavioral limit in a calm voice, and summon assistance according to protocol.

C) Match the client’s volume and direct the client to sit down immediately.

Question 23

> In family counseling, parents and their adult daughter disagree about her dating choices. The parents describe protecting family values, while the daughter describes wanting respect for her adulthood. Each asks the counselor to endorse one side.

What is the counselor's best intervention?

A) Elicit what protection, respect, and family connection mean to each person and identify shared hopes before negotiating differences.

B) Explain that the adult daughter's autonomy makes the parents' cultural concerns irrelevant to counseling.

C) Support the parents' position because family counseling should preserve existing family values.

Question 24

In an acceptance-based intervention, what is the main purpose of cognitive defusion?

A) To replace each negative thought with a more objectively positive statement.

B) To identify the childhood event that originally produced the thought.

C) To help the client experience thoughts as mental events rather than commands or literal facts.

Question 25

> One week after a motor vehicle crash, a client reports being startled by horns and briefly feeling as if the crash is happening again. The client is safe, functioning with support, and asks, "Am I going crazy?"

How should the counselor respond?

A) State that the symptoms confirm a trauma-related disorder and begin long-term trauma processing.

B) Advise avoiding traffic sounds until the reactions have completely stopped.

C) Normalize that such reactions can occur after a frightening event, teach present-orientation skills, and explain when additional help is warranted.

Question 26

> A client has sent several late-night noncrisis messages to the counselor, although the informed-consent agreement states that messages are checked only during business hours. The client says the messages provide relief even without a reply.

What should the counselor do in session?

A) Continue allowing the messages because the client does not expect a response.

B) Validate the need for relief, restate the communication boundary, and develop acceptable between-session coping and contact options.

C) Block the client's number outside business hours so the limit is enforced consistently.

Question 27

> A client describes coercive control by a partner but denies immediate danger and does not want to leave the relationship today. The client wants to feel more prepared if the situation worsens.

Which response best supports safety and empowerment?

A) Tell the client that leaving immediately is the only responsible choice.

B) Respect the client's decision while collaboratively developing a personalized safety plan and reviewing confidential support options.

C) Recommend couple counseling so both partners can negotiate rules for the relationship.

Question 28

What is the central purpose of blocking in a counseling group?

A) To prevent members from discussing topics that may produce strong emotion.

B) To interrupt behavior that impairs safety or productive participation while keeping the member engaged.

C) To stop a member whenever the leader disagrees with the member's perspective.

Question 29

After immediate physical safety has been established, which principle generally guides early psychological crisis support?

A) Offer practical assistance, connection, and coping support without requiring detailed emotional disclosure.

B) Encourage a complete retelling of the event before discussing present needs.

C) Delay supportive intervention until the person displays a predictable emotional reaction.

Question 30

> One partner says, "When I talk about a hard day, I want understanding." The other replies, "I offer solutions because doing nothing feels uncaring." Their conversations usually end with both feeling rejected.

Which in-session intervention is most appropriate?

A) Ask each partner to prepare a list of preferred solutions before discussing another stressful event.

B) Coach one partner to describe the experience while the other reflects the feeling and asks whether empathy or problem solving is wanted.

C) Advise the solution-focused partner to stop offering suggestions during all future conversations.

Question 31

> During a group session, one member makes a demeaning comment about immigrants. Another member becomes tense and silent, while several others look toward the leader.

What is the leader's best immediate intervention?

A) Wait to see whether group members challenge the comment without leader influence.

B) Move to a less controversial topic and speak privately with both members after the session.

C) Interrupt the comment, name its potential impact, reaffirm group expectations, and invite affected members to choose whether to respond.

Question 32

What is the primary purpose of linking in group counseling?

A) To redirect a member whose comments are unrelated to the group's stated topic.

B) To summarize the leader's interpretation before the group moves to another issue.

C) To connect members with shared themes so they can respond directly to one another.

Question 33

> A transgender client worries about being harassed when using public transportation after several prior incidents. A thought record labels the prediction "Someone may target me" as irrational, and the client says the exercise feels dismissive.

How should the counselor modify the intervention?

A) Continue challenging the prediction until the client can identify evidence that public transit is generally safe.

B) Avoid discussing the fear because addressing discrimination may strengthen the client's anxiety.

C) Distinguish realistic safety concerns from anxiety-driven predictions and develop coping and safety choices with the client.

Question 34

> A client uses sarcasm while describing a painful breakup. The counselor laughs briefly, and the client becomes serious and says, "I wasn't making a joke."

What is the counselor's best response?

A) "Sarcasm often gives people relief from painful emotions, which is why I responded that way."

B) "I understand now. Please continue with what happened after the breakup."

C) "You're right; my laugh missed how painful this is for you. I'm sorry. What was that response like for you?"

PART B — ANSWER KEY AND EXPLANATIONS

Answers match the numbered items in Part A.

Question 1 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Pause, acknowledge the loss of control, and present one option at a time while requesting consent before each next step.

Explanation: A trauma-informed response reduces cognitive load and restores choice after an experience involving profound loss of control. Making referrals without consent or requiring an immediate decision from a long list would reproduce pressure rather than support stabilization.

Question 2 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Practice early urge awareness and a competing response that makes pulling difficult for a brief period.

Explanation: Awareness training and a competing response directly target the cue-behavior sequence and match the client's request for a concrete method. Public embarrassment is not a therapeutic mechanism, and symbolic analysis does not teach an alternative response to the urge.

Question 3 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Explore both commitments and help the student frame coping goals in a way that can support personal well-being and valued family relationships.

Explanation: This response makes room for the student's relational values and individual needs without treating them as mutually exclusive. Secrecy may intensify conflict, while labeling family loyalty as a barrier imposes an individualistic standard.

Question 4 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Develop an implementation intention specifying when, where, and how the client will begin with the friend's support.

Explanation: An implementation intention turns a vague goal into a concrete cue-and-action plan and incorporates support the client has already chosen. Requiring solitary completion ignores the identified barrier, while visualizing consequences does not specify how action will start.

Question 5 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Help the client create a less distressing ending and rehearse the revised dream imagery while awake.

Explanation: Imagery rehearsal involves revising the nightmare script and repeatedly practicing the new imagery during waking hours. Replaying the unchanged nightmare is not the defining technique, and symbolic interpretation is not required for this intervention.

Question 6 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Explain that counseling is collaborative, describe how the counselor and client may work together, and ask what kind of help the client expected.

Explanation: Clear orientation reduces uncertainty while inviting the client's expectations and preferences into the working relationship. Promising solutions misrepresents counseling, and immediately shifting to assessment leaves the process question unanswered.

Question 7 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Collaboratively specify the experiment, the predicted outcome, and what observations the client will record.

Explanation: A behavioral experiment is most informative when the prediction, test, and observable data are defined in advance. Reassurance asks the client to accept the counselor's belief, while using a high-stakes task introduces unnecessary risk into an initial test.

Question 8 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Acknowledge the importance, clarify enough to support containment, and agree on how to return to it promptly.

Explanation: This response respects both the significance of the disclosure and the real session boundary. It avoids opening material that cannot be held adequately while ensuring the client does not experience the concern as dismissed.

Question 9 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Identify warning signs, internal coping steps, supportive contacts, professional resources, and ways to reduce access to lethal means.

Explanation: A collaborative safety plan provides a sequenced set of personalized actions and supports for managing increased risk. A no-harm promise is not a substitute for intervention, and a crisis-line number alone omits internal coping, social support, and means-safety steps.

Question 10 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Create an external cue at 7:00 p.m. and rehearse a specific sequence for pausing the game and opening the assignment.

Explanation: An external cue and rehearsed transition reduce reliance on time awareness and momentary motivation. The intervention translates the student's realistic start time into an observable sequence that can be practiced and adjusted.

Question 11 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Slow the pace, ask each partner to speak for themself, and explore the quieter partner's preferred language support.

Explanation: The counselor protects each partner's voice and seeks the quieter partner's own communication preference rather than assuming what support is needed. Letting one partner routinely answer for the other can conceal meaning and reinforce an unequal interaction.

Question 12 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Explain what the note-taking is for, invite the client's reaction, and collaborate on an adjustment that supports connection.

Explanation: Transparency and collaborative adjustment respond to the client's concern without assuming that all documentation must end. Simple reassurance would fail to address the client's lived experience of disconnection.

Question 13 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Establish a limited scheduled worry period and practice redirecting worry to that period when it appears earlier.

Explanation: Scheduled worry contains rather than suppresses the process and gives the client a structured response when worries arise. Trying to prove that every feared outcome is impossible can become another form of reassurance and is unrealistic in the face of uncertainty.

Question 14 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: "You're wondering whether I'm disappointed. What did you notice from me that led you to ask?"

Explanation: The response reflects the client's concern and invites exploration of the immediate relational cue without defensively denying it. A generic statement about counselor training does not clarify what occurred between this client and counselor.

Question 15 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: "Your answers were clear, and I had difficulty hearing the last two. Would you like to practice them at a stronger volume?"

Explanation: Constructive feedback is specific, behaviorally observable, balanced, and connected to an immediate opportunity for practice. A global judgment about confidence is less precise and can sound evaluative rather than collaborative.

Question 16 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Name the pattern, ask the member what would support participation, and invite the group to tolerate a slower pace.

Explanation: This intervention protects the member's opportunity to participate while inviting the member's own preferences and making the group process visible. Requiring prepared statements shifts the burden entirely to the member, while total silence from others imposes an inflexible rule without collaboration.

Question 17 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Maintain respect for the client while openly exploring the behavior, its effects, and responsibility for change.

Explanation: Unconditional positive regard concerns the client's worth as a person, not approval of every action. The counselor can maintain acceptance while addressing harm honestly and supporting accountability.

Question 18 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Remind the client of the agreement and coach the client to notice anxiety without resolving the uncertainty.

Explanation: Response prevention requires interrupting reassurance seeking while helping the client remain in contact with uncertainty and anxiety. Providing reassurance would offer short-term relief but reinforce the cycle that the planned intervention is intended to change.

Question 19 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: “Being the person everyone depends on seems closely tied to how you measure your worth.”

Explanation: This response identifies the personal significance underlying the described responsibilities and therefore reflects meaning. The other responses accurately restate events or emotion but do not reach the client’s implied belief about worth.

Question 20 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Explain that early reactions can include numbness, then ask what immediate support would feel most helpful.

Explanation: Numbness can be an acute response to sudden loss and does not by itself mean that the client is reacting incorrectly. Brief normalization followed by attention to the client’s immediate support needs is more appropriate than forcing emotional disclosure or assigning a defensive interpretation.

Question 21 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Invite the child to show what school has been like with the figures and let the child explain the arrangement.

Explanation: A developmentally responsive invitation uses the child’s spontaneous mode of engagement while preserving the child’s authority over meaning. Assigning a fixed interpretation to the figures would substitute the counselor’s assumption for the child’s explanation.

Question 22 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Create distance toward the accessible exit, state a clear behavioral limit in a calm voice, and summon assistance according to protocol.

Explanation: Threatening proximity and clenched fists require the counselor to prioritize physical safety while using calm, clear communication and the stated agency procedure. Remaining seated reduces access to the exit, and escalating volume may increase danger.

Question 23 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Elicit what protection, respect, and family connection mean to each person and identify shared hopes before negotiating differences.

Explanation: Exploring meanings and shared aims lets the family work with both autonomy and relationship values without making the counselor an arbiter. Automatically privileging either position would flatten the family’s cultural and developmental complexity.

Question 24 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: To help the client experience thoughts as mental events rather than commands or literal facts.

Explanation: Cognitive defusion changes the client's relationship to thoughts by reducing automatic fusion with their literal content. It does not require proving thoughts false or tracing each one to an early event.

Question 25 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Normalize that such reactions can occur after a frightening event, teach present-orientation skills, and explain when additional help is warranted.

Explanation: Brief normalization can reduce catastrophic interpretations while present-orientation provides a practical response to reminders. The available information does not justify declaring a disorder, and broad avoidance may maintain fear and restrict functioning.

Question 26 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Validate the need for relief, restate the communication boundary, and develop acceptable between-session coping and contact options.

Explanation: The counselor can respond empathically to the function of the messages while maintaining the informed boundary and building workable alternatives. Ignoring the pattern weakens the agreement, whereas abruptly blocking contact does not provide collaborative transition or coping support.

Question 27 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Respect the client's decision while collaboratively developing a personalized safety plan and reviewing confidential support options.

Explanation: Client-centered safety planning supports preparation and access to help without coercing a decision the client is not ready to make. Couple counseling may be unsafe or inappropriate in a context of coercive control because open disclosure can increase risk.

Question 28 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: To interrupt behavior that impairs safety or productive participation while keeping the member engaged.

Explanation: Blocking sets a limit on a harmful group behavior while preserving the person's opportunity to participate constructively. It is not a method for eliminating emotion or suppressing viewpoints that differ from the leader's.

Question 29 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Offer practical assistance, connection, and coping support without requiring detailed emotional disclosure.

Explanation: Early crisis support typically emphasizes current needs, social connection, and manageable coping after safety is established. Required retelling can increase distress and assumes that immediate emotional processing is necessary for everyone.

Question 30 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Coach one partner to describe the experience while the other reflects the feeling and asks whether empathy or problem solving is wanted.

Explanation: Structured rehearsal helps the partners distinguish emotional attunement from solution giving and practice checking what response is desired. Banning all suggestions is overly rigid and would not teach the couple how to coordinate different support needs.

Question 31 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Interrupt the comment, name its potential impact, reaffirm group expectations, and invite affected members to choose whether to respond.

Explanation: Prompt intervention protects the group climate and makes clear that demeaning speech will not be left unaddressed. Inviting rather than requiring a response avoids placing the burden of correction on members who may have been harmed.

Question 32 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: To connect members with shared themes so they can respond directly to one another.

Explanation: Linking moves communication among members by highlighting common experiences or themes. It strengthens member-to-member interaction rather than keeping the leader at the center of every exchange.

Question 33 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Distinguish realistic safety concerns from anxiety-driven predictions and develop coping and safety choices with the client.

Explanation: Effective cognitive work must account for credible discrimination rather than classify every feared outcome as distorted. Collaboratively separating realistic risk from anxiety amplification supports both safety and coping without invalidating the client's experience.

Question 34 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: "You're right; my laugh missed how painful this is for you. I'm sorry. What was that response like for you?"

Explanation: The counselor directly acknowledges the misattunement, apologizes, and invites discussion of its relational impact. Explaining the laugh or quickly returning to the story would center the counselor's intent rather than repair what the client experienced.
